

Unity 2

UI vs UX

The concepts of UI and UX frequently are misunderstood and misused. Using as reference the following article: "UX vs UI: What's the Difference? (And How They Apply to WordPress)" provide a clear difference between the concepts. Use two examples based on your team project to clarify each concept. The examples of UI and UX must be specific and clearly explained: <https://wpmudev.com/blog/ux-ui-wordpress/>

Although the concepts of UI and UX are often misunderstood and misused, they work together to create a better product.

While user experience (UX) focuses more on user satisfaction by optimally developing usability and working on the user's potential emotional responses, the UI or user interface is the physical part that allows the user to interact with the product.

A clear way to see that difference is in a real world project.

In our project two UX elements that I can perceive are:

- Gamification, for example, allowing you to create a "dream team" to compete in team challenges, having a "learning path," or having "trophies", the reason why is because UX answers the question: Do your customers enjoy interacting with your product?
- The flows, which we try to make as intuitive as possible, such as selecting a course or sharing an achievement on LinkedIn. This is UX, since according to what the reviewed reference tells us, one of the jobs of UX designers is to ensure that your website's structure flows logically from one step to the next.

While two UI elements are:

- The hierarchy of texts and titles in the learning path
- Familiar icons (a hallmark of a good interface according to the reference reviewed), such as a medal to view achievements or a share, to put your achievement in LinkedIn.

These are UI elements since they are the ones we can physically perceive and they provide a way to interact with the product.

J. Sawers. 2021. UX vs UI: What's the Difference and Why it Matters for WordPress. *WPMU DEV Blog*, April 20, 2021. Retrieved May 5, 2025 from <https://wpmudev.com/blog/ux-ui-wordpress/>

UIDesignPatterns

UI Design Patterns represent "reusable/recurring components which designers use to solve common problems in user interface design". As proved solutions for regular interactions/UI designs, the patterns are often on UI Toolkits or UI Guidelines. During the process of selecting a toolkit/guidelines it is important to verify if basic UI patterns are present. Select a task (team project) of your UI/prototype designed so far. Define a relevant UI pattern and determine if it was applied or it should be. Either case, describe a specific implementation of the UI pattern and the relevance of it based on project's usability goals.

In this second review, to develop the prototypes in Figma we dropped everything we had done and started from scratch, thinking about the "Persona", we focused on their desires and needs to generate the requirements and the prototype, however something we did differently than before is generate the UI with a figma UI toolkit, most of the components are based on this.

Some features have interesting UI patterns thanks to the figma UI toolkit, for example, in the team building functionality for group activities, the Clear Primary Actions pattern is implemented, which makes buttons stand out with color so users know which actions have priority.

However, in my opinion, many patterns were missing that could have added value, such as "steps left", despite having a progress bar, it is not clear how many steps it takes for a user to complete a certain task, so I came to the conclusion that using a UI toolkit does not automatically provide the use of UI Design Patterns and we must be aware of which patterns really bring us value.

Interaction Design Foundation - IxDF. 2016. What are User Interface (UI) Design Patterns?
Retrieved May 6, 2025 from
<https://www.interaction-design.org/literature/topics/ui-design-patterns>

Invited Talk

Based on invited talks use some of the topics and reflect on how it could be applied for your team project. Provide specific examples on how the concept, technique, method, tool or activity could be useful for the team project. Remember to mention the specific comment and explain clearly how it could be implemented specifically as part of the project

In the presentation made by the UI Senior Engineer, Eduardo Pamplona, on Friday, February 28th, one of the main aspects that caught my attention and that we can apply in our work team is the life cycle of the feature, especially the first three phases: first, detect a problem or opportunity, research/investigate regarding that problem, design and/or refine. It is also important to mention that this is a cyclical process.

I consider these first three steps of the feature lifecycle to be very useful to carry out in our project, since despite the fact that we come with prior knowledge of the softskills app, we are a little biased about what we think the app should have, and/or what we think users want, that is why we carried out research and a survey and although we produced UIs, we went back to work on reading the data obtained, focusing on the person and rewriting and redesigning, if we had not done prior research and continued refining until we obtained a good product, we would have simply remained stuck with what we think we know.